

CANONICAL LESSON

Housing Need Beyond Counts

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

Production Unit	PU-B07-C51
Notebook	V7_D_N01
Status	Controlled educational draft v0.1
Data boundary	Synthetic instructional data only

Central decision: Assess housing need through households, adequacy, affordability, location, tenure context, supply, displacement risk, and uncertainty—not dwelling counts alone.

Learning outcomes

Why this matters

Unit counts can conceal unaffordability, overcrowding, poor quality, exclusion, and housing that is disconnected from livelihoods and services.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

Worked cross-sector example

A city compares household formation, rents, incomes, vacancies, housing quality, and location before defining an intervention.

Boundary: The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Add overcrowding and dwelling-quality indicators.
- 2.
- Model supply completion.
- 3.

- Compare area and household measures.
- 4.
- Explain why vacancy does not imply immediately usable housing.

Answer key

- 1.
- Define occupancy norm and quality dimensions with survey uncertainty.
- 2.
- Use permits, starts, completion probabilities, delays, demolitions, and conversions.
- 3.
- Area averages describe places; household distributions describe people and may reveal inequality hidden by averages.
- 4.
- Vacant units may be seasonal, uninhabitable, mismatched, speculative, legally unavailable, or unaffordable.

Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.